found people there that now compose my dream of Europe. They are Afro-European and other Black Europeans, these hyphenated people who, in concert with other people of the African Diaspora are increasing forces for international change."[87] Berlin, the city she dwelled in and mapped in numerous ways, offered her a place to rethink and dream diaspora into existence.

In her remarks at the conference, she continued to weigh her status as an insider/outsider and riffing on dynamics of estrangement. She maintained distance despite the personal connections she forged for herself in Berlin. She noted, "I am an outsider, dreaming of Europe,"[88] while addressing a group she had cooperatively called into formation. Lorde's Berlin was a site of pilgrimage not only for joy or release but also to embody what she envisioned as "international change."

In the late 1980s, Lorde continued with her prolific period, as she continued to treat her terminal illness. Echoes of her earlier trips continued to mark her cultural productions. In *A Burst of Light*, her second volume of collected essays and a body of edited journal entries, as she had done with her previous *Cancer Journals* (1979) from her bout with breast cancer, she includes dozens of edited journal entries with embedded poetic and prose fragments to trace her processes of work, travel, and healing from cancer. The later entries span from 1984 to 1987. She reveals over time that though her living in West Berlin afforded her relief and a new form of homeopathic treatment, which inspired returns to Europe, she was in fact suffering from liver metastases. As in her earlier *Cancer Journals*, Lorde details conversations and thought experiments during her illness that more broadly pertain to her own creative process.

Though many of her poems dealt with similar issues of Cold War geopolitics and diaspora, her *A Burst of Light* prose and published journals indicated a commitment to poetics of diaspora by weaving together disparate written forms. In doing so, she emphasizes the poetic and travel methodologies that underwrote all of her work inspired by her time in Berlin. For example, her essay "Apartheid U.S.A." was written as a pamphlet in 1985 and reprinted in *A Burst of Light*. Lorde opens the essay with a similar approach, reading and intervening into divided urban spaces: "New York City, 1985. The high sign that rules this summer is increasing fragmentation." Lorde reads this "fragmentation" as a pitfall of the way violence is not only shaping the city but is mistreated in official narratives.